



STARTING OUT Zail Singh (centre), then President of India, inaugurates the first Apollo hospital in Chennai in 1983. To Singh's right is Dr Prathap C. Reddy

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What were the challenges you faced in India?

There were many challenges. Back then, the hospitals struggled to secure loans from banks and were not recognised as an industry, making access to funds difficult. Medical equipment was often treated as luxury items [and were] subject

to 100% duty. These disparities compelled me to take action.

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The name 'Apollo' carries profound significance in healing. How did you decide on it?

The credit goes to Suneeta, my second daughter. Initially, I assumed she referred to

the Apollo moon landing, but she clarified that it was inspired by the Greek god Apollo, known for his healing abilities. I decided on 'Apollo Hospitals' to convey a global message, signifying India's prowess in healthcare. My vision extended beyond a single hospital, aiming to establish many.

One achievement was connecting my village [to a doctor for the world's first teleconsultation] during [US President] Bill Clinton's visit to India in 2000. A child from my village underwent examination by a doctor via satellite link... and [was] successfully treated at my hospital. This initiative received international recognition and paved the way for similar projects worldwide.

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Could you shed light on Apollo's evolution and expansion and how it has contributed to the Indian healthcare landscape?

From the seed of an idea, the hospital has blossomed into a global healthcare leader. We envision India becoming a central source of skilled professionals, benefitting both the nation and the world... I believe that when you encounter a

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2006-2013

Enters Bengaluru; launches Cyber-Knife robotic surgery system in Chennai; becomes the world's busiest solid organ transplant centre; performs more than 130,000 cardiac surgeries

2014-2016

Introduces AskApollo and Apollo Diagnostics; launches Apollo Medical College

2017-2023

Completes more than 1,500 bone marrow transplants; launches Apollo ProHealth; delivers 8 million+ vaccinations